



O/Ref: HLC-CTX-SPO-NEI-018-26

Kigali, 12^{sd} May 2026

To: FERWAFA

(Conflicts Resolution Committee)

Subject: Complaint Against MUHAZI UNITED FC for Persistent Non-Payment of Salaries

Dear Committee Members,

Acting on behalf of our client Mr. NZANA EBINI INIACE, residing in Gisenyi, Rwanda, holder of Passport No. AA578407, we, *Hope Law Chambers*, a law firm located at KG 376 St Kibagabaga, Kigali, Rwanda, represented by our Managing Partner Barrister STEVE MASSIEGMO, Attorney duly registered with the Cameroon and Rwanda Bar Associations, hereby respectfully submit the present complaint before the Conflicts Resolution Committee of FERWAFA regarding the persistent non-payment of our client's salaries by MUHAZI UNITED FC, despite several reminders and a formal notice previously addressed to the club.

Whereas, our client signed an employment contract with MUHAZI UNITED FC on 11 August 2023 for a duration of two years. Under the terms of this contract, he was entitled to receive a monthly salary of 350,000 RWF in consideration for the professional services he rendered to the club as a football player.

Throughout his engagement with MUHAZI UNITED FC, our client fulfilled his obligations professionally and in good faith. At no point was he accused of misconduct, indiscipline, poor performance, or any breach capable of justifying the suspension or withholding of his salary.

However, despite the clear contractual obligations binding the club, MUHAZI UNITED FC failed to pay our client's salaries for the months of April and May 2025, amounting to a total sum of 700,000 RWF. Following repeated reminders, the club only made a partial payment of 100,000 RWF, while assuring our client that the remaining balance would shortly be settled. Unfortunately, that promise

was never respected. To date, the outstanding balance of **600,000 RWF** remains unpaid without any valid explanation from the club.

Concerned by this continued breach, and in a genuine effort to resolve the matter amicably, our office addressed a formal letter of notice to MUHAZI UNITED FC on 16 April 2026, formally requesting the payment of the outstanding salaries and inviting the club to regularize the situation before the matter could be brought before the competent authorities. Despite the seriousness of the issues raised and despite the respect shown by our client throughout the process, we did not receive any response whatsoever from the club. MUHAZI UNITED FC remained completely silent and failed to take any step toward resolving the dispute.

This prolonged silence and refusal to honor its obligations have caused serious prejudice to our client. As a professional football player whose livelihood depends entirely on the salary earned from his sporting activities, our client has faced significant financial difficulties as a result of the club's failure to pay him. Beyond the financial aspect, this situation has deeply affected his peace of mind, dignity, and professional stability. It is particularly painful for a player who served his club loyally and fulfilled all of his obligations to be abandoned without remuneration, without explanations, and without consideration.

This matter could have been resolved amicably had the club shown the slightest willingness to cooperate. Our client remained patient for several months in the hope that MUHAZI UNITED FC would simply respect the commitments it freely undertook under the employment contract. Unfortunately, the club's continued silence and inaction have left him with no alternative but to seek the intervention of FERWAFa.

Accordingly, we respectfully request the Committee to order MUHAZI UNITED FC to fully compensate our client for the prejudice suffered as a result of these persistent contractual breaches.

The total amount claimed by our client in the present matter is Ten Million Six Hundred Fifty Thousand Rwandan Francs (**10,650,000 RWF**), representing the outstanding salary arrears owed to him as well as the various damages suffered as a direct consequence of MUHAZI UNITED FC's persistent failure to comply with its contractual obligations, broken down as follows:

- 600,000 RWF: Outstanding salary arrears for April and May 2025 (after deduction of the advance payment);

- 1,050,000 RWF: Financial damages resulting from prolonged non-payment of salaries;
- 5,000,000 RWF: Compensation for moral damages suffered by our client;
- 4,000,000 RWF: Damages for professional prejudice.

In light of the foregoing, we respectfully request the Committee to order MUHAZI UNITED FC to pay the outstanding amounts claimed above and to recognize the prejudice suffered by our client due to the prolonged non-payment of his lawful remuneration.

We also ask the Committee to take any additional measures or sanctions it considers appropriate in accordance with the applicable FERWAFa regulations.

We remain at your disposal should any further information or supporting documents be required.

Yours sincerely,



Me Steve Idrix MASSIEGMO



EG/ER

Kigali, 16 April 2026.

To: MUHAZI UNITED FC

Reprinted by Mr MFIZI NKAKA LOGIN

Subject: Invitation to an amicable settlement including a formal notice
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Dear Mr. MFIZI,

By way of introduction, we are Hope Law Chambers, a law firm located in Kigali City, at KG 376 St Kibagabaga, represented by Barrister Steve MASSIEGMO, Attorney duly registered with Rwanda Bar Associations, and we are acting on behalf of our client Mr. NZANA EBINI INIACE, a professional football player of the first division team in the football club that you represent. Through this correspondence, we are drawing your attention to the serious breaches observed in the employment relationship between our client and your club, which could lead to lengthy and cumbersome legal proceedings, not to mention the potential financial costs involved for MUHAZI UNITED FC.

On 11 August 2023, you, acting as President and legal representative of MUHAZI UNITED FC, and our client entered into a written employment contract numbered 004/2023-2024. Under the terms of this contract, the duration was agreed as two years, renewable, and our client was entitled to a net monthly salary of three hundred fifty thousand Rwandan Francs (350,000 RWF) in return for the faithful performance of his contractual duties, including, inter alia, attending training sessions, participating in official matches, and adhering to the rules and regulations of the team and the Rwanda Football Federation (FERWAF).

The contract was signed by both parties on the same date in Rwamagana and was to be implemented as from the start of the 2023-2024 championship.

Despite this clearly defined contractual arrangement, our client has been experiencing serious difficulties in receiving his agreed monthly salaries during in his engagement with your club.

Specifically, your club failed to pay his salaries for the months of April and May 2025, which together amount to seven hundred thousand Rwandan Francs (700,000 RWF).

After several reminders from our client, your club paid him an advance of one hundred thousand Rwandan Francs (100,000 RWF) against this debt, and you promised that the remaining balance would be paid in the coming days.

To date, despite your express promise, you have not paid the remaining balance of six hundred thousand Rwandan Francs (600,000 RWF), nor have you provided any valid justification for this non-payment. On 17 February 2026, our client addressed to you a formal notice requesting full payment within eight days. That deadline has long passed, and your club has continued to remain in breach of its contractual obligations without any further payment or explanation.

It is important to emphasize that this persistent non-payment has had a significant impact on our client's daily life. Indeed, as a professional footballer entirely dependent on his salary, our client has been exposed to serious financial difficulties, including inability to meet his basic needs such as housing, food, and medical care. Furthermore, the uncertainty created by your repeated failures to honor the contractual obligations has caused our client considerable moral and psychological prejudice, including stress, anxiety, and damage to his professional reputation and future career prospects.

Besides, it is worth recalling that at no point did you or any representative of MUHAZI UNITED FC report any misconduct, prohibited acts, poor performance, or violation of club rules on the part of our client that could have justified withholding his salary or suspending payments as provided under the Article 10 of his employment contract.

In fact, you have never invoked any of these grounds against our client, nor have you initiated any disciplinary proceedings. Consequently, the salary entitlement for the months of April and May 2025 remains fully due and payable under the terms of Article 1 of the contract, and your club remains in clear and indefensible breach.

Beyond the contractual provisions, **Law No. 66/2018 of 30 August 2018 regulating labour** in Rwanda applies to our client's employment relationship with your club. Indeed, Article 66 of the said law provides that "**An employee is entitled to a salary for the work performed**", and your club's failure to pay our client's salaries for April and May 2025, for which work was duly performed, constitutes a clear violation of this statutory entitlement.

Furthermore, **Article 81 of Law No. 45/2011 governing contracts** provides that "**Total breach of the contract gives right to damages based on the non-performed obligations.**" While our client's contract has not been formally terminated, your persistent refusal to pay his agreed salaries constitutes a total breach of the employment contract, entitling our client to claim damages for all obligations you have failed to perform.

In light of the foregoing, we hereby demand, on behalf of our client, not only the payment of the outstanding salaries but also compensation for the multiple categories of damages he has suffered as a result of your breaches.

I. ON THE CLAIM FOR UNPAID SALARIES (APRIL AND MAY 2025)

Your club owes our client the sum of six hundred thousand Rwandan Francs (600,000 RWF) representing the balance for April and May 2025 after deduction of the advance of one hundred thousand Rwandan Francs (100,000 RWF) that you paid. This amount is calculated as follows:

- Salary for April 2025 in the sum of three hundred fifty thousand Rwandan Francs (350,000 RWF); and,
- Salary for May 2025 in the sum of three hundred fifty thousand Rwandan Francs (350,000 RWF); minus the advance payment of one hundred thousand Rwandan Francs (100,000 RWF).

This leaves a net outstanding balance of six hundred thousand Rwandan Francs (600,000 RWF).

II. CONCERNING THE CLAIM FOR FINANCIAL DAMAGES RESULTING FROM PROLONGED NON-PAYMENT OF SALARIES

By failing to pay our client's salaries for over eleven months despite repeated reminders, your club has caused him significant financial prejudice that extends beyond the mere principal amount. Indeed, our client has been deprived of the use of his lawfully earned wages, has been forced to borrow money or incur debt to meet his basic needs, and has suffered from the effects of inflation and the time value of money.

We therefore claim damages equivalent to three months' salary, amounting to one million fifty thousand Rwandan Francs (3,500,000 RWF), as compensation for the prolonged deprivation of his lawful earnings and the resulting hardship.

III. REGARDING THE MORAL DAMAGES

Your persistent breach of contract has caused our client significant moral prejudice. In fact, he has endured sustained stress, anxiety, and emotional distress as a direct result of your club's failure to honor its contractual obligations. More, his professional reputation has been damaged, as he has been unable to meet his financial commitments and has suffered public embarrassment. Additionally, the uncertainty regarding his financial situation has negatively affected his mental health and overall well-being.

As a result, we claim compensation for moral damages in the sum of five hundred thousand Rwandan Francs (5,000,000 RWF), which represent fair and reasonable compensation for the psychological suffering, emotional distress, reputational harm, and loss of personal dignity endured by our client as a direct consequence of your club's persistent contractual breaches and prolonged failure to pay his lawful remuneration.

IV. CONCERNING THE PROFESSIONAL PREJUDICE

Your club's failure to pay salaries has materially impaired our client's ability to perform his professional duties under normal and dignified working conditions. As a professional athlete, sustained performance requires financial stability, proper preparation, and psychological concentration.

The prolonged non-payment of remuneration has placed our client in a situation of professional instability, preventing him from maintaining the level of preparation and focus required of a professional athlete. Without regular salary payments, our client has faced difficulties in meeting essential professional expenses related to training, recovery, nutrition, and personal preparation, all of which directly influence athletic performance.

This situation has inevitably affected his sporting consistency, limited his ability to fully exploit competitive opportunities, and weakened his professional positioning within the football market, thereby adversely impacting his career development and future contractual prospects.

Accordingly, we claim damages in the sum of **Four Million Rwandan Francs (4,000,000 RWF)** as compensation for the professional prejudice suffered by our client as a direct consequence of your club's persistent failure to comply with its contractual obligations.

V. TOTAL AMOUNT CLAIMED

The total amount claimed under this formal notice is Ten Million Six Hundred Fifty Thousand Rwandan Francs (10,650,000 RWF), broken down as follows:

- 600,000 RWF: Outstanding salary arrears for April and May 2025 (after deduction of the advance payment);
- 1,050,000 RWF: Financial damages resulting from prolonged non-payment of salaries;
- 5,000,000 RWF: Compensation for moral damages suffered by our client;
- 4,000,000 RWF: Damages for professional prejudice.

Total Amount Claimed: 10,650,000 RWF

We reserve the right to increase the above amounts should the matter proceed to arbitration or litigation, including additional damages for bad faith, statutory default interest calculated from the date each salary fell due, compensation for any further prejudice revealed during proceedings, as well as all legal fees incurred by our client.

We also reserve the right to add claims for any other contractual benefits that may have been withheld, including match-winning bonuses and the recruitment fee provided under Article 1 of the contract, should supporting evidence arise.

In order to avoid formal arbitration or judicial proceedings, we invite you to resolve this matter amicably by contacting our offices within forty-eight (48) hours of receipt of this letter to reach a consensual settlement, with full payment to be made within fifteen (15) days from the date of agreement;

Should you fail to respond within forty-eight (48) hours, should you refuse to pay the amounts claimed, or should you fail to propose a reasonable payment schedule acceptable to our client, we will have no choice but to refer the matter to the arbitration bodies of FERWAFa in accordance with Article 13 of the employment contract, and if necessary to the competent courts, where your club will be liable for the full outstanding amounts, additional damages, default interest, court costs, and attorney's fees, without further notice.

Finally, be advised that we reserve the right to publish this claim and any resulting judgment in relevant football and legal publications should your club fail to comply.

Respectfully yours,

Me Steve Idrix MASSIEGMO





Kome Kome 21/04/2026 NBEREZAKO MENESEHEJE
MUHAZI UNITED FC IHAGARARWE NA MFIZI
NKAKA LOGIN Ibar koryiyo barwana Nkoresheje
uburyo kwikorana buhanga bwa E-MAIL
BAGANZWE BAKORESHA (ART 47 CPCCSA)
Joutade H, P Me KANYABIGUNDA GODEFROID

EG/ER

Kanyabigunda



Kigali, 16 April 2026.

To: MUHAZI UNITED FC

Represented by Mr MFIZI NKAKA LOGIN

Subject: Invitation to an amicable settlement including a formal notice

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Dear Mr. MFIZI,

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The contract was signed by both parties on the same date in Rwamagana and was to be implemented as from the start of the 2023-2024 championship.

Despite this clearly defined contractual arrangement, our client has been experiencing serious difficulties in receiving his agreed monthly salaries during in his engagement with your club.



Kanyabigunda Godfroid <godfroidkanyabigunda@gmail.com>

Invitation to an amicable settlement including a formal notice

1 message

Kanyabigunda Godfroid <godfroidkanyabigunda@gmail.com>

Tue, Apr 21, 2026 at 6:38 PM

To: "muhaziunitedfc@gmail.com" <muhaziunitedfc@gmail.com>

NONE KUWA 21/04/2026 NDEMEZAKO MENYESHEJE MUHAZI UNITED FC IHAGARARIWE NA MFIZI NKAKA
LOGIN KOPI YIBARUWA BANDIKIWE NA HOPE LAW CHAMBERS NKORESHEJE UBURYO
BWIKORANABUHANGA BWA E-MAIL BASANZANZWE BAKORESHA NKUKO BITEGANYWA NAMATEGEKO (ART
47 CPCCSA)

DONT ACTE

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